

# Zadkiel AHARONIAN

Developer · Platform Engineer · SRE · Open Source

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I build **developer platforms** for teams that need reliable Kubernetes, GitOps and delivery without turning product teams into platform experts. I have run **Kubernetes at scale** across public and sovereign clouds, on-prem and the edge. My work sits at the intersection of developer experience, reliability and open source, with **1,000+ merged upstream PRs**. I am now exploring how agentic AI reshapes platform engineering.

## EXPERIENCE

**Cloud Specialist** · Airbus Aircraft Jun 2024 — Present  
Cloud-native and edge platforms for next-generation onboard aircraft systems.

- Delivered **5+ MVPs** for next-generation onboard platforms, from concept to production-ready.
- Designed **Kubernetes foundations** for onboard application management and rollout-constrained environments.
- Built a Varnish-powered **onboard video distribution system** for content delivery.
- Enabled **real-time computer vision** at the edge on Jetson/GPU hardware with optimized pipelines.
- Built an AWS landing zone (Control Tower, AFT) with **self-service account vending**, and designed its dev-to-prod security gates.

**DevOps Consultant** · CCL Consulting Apr 2019 — Present  
Kubernetes platform engineering and DevOps consulting across public and sovereign clouds.

- Led development of a **self-service Kubernetes platform product** that provisions clusters and a complete, batteries-included app ecosystem from declarative config across local, cloud and bare-metal, with layered Helm/Kustomize composition and automated SBOM/dependency discovery.
- Developed a **Kubernetes compliance engine** for real-time security and best-practice visibility across developers, compliance teams and operators.
- Delivering platform maintenance and enhancements across client environments using immutable infrastructure, GitOps workflows and modern security practices to 10+ client teams.

**Site Reliability Engineer** · Carrefour Dec 2020 — May 2024  
Internal Kubernetes platform team for Carrefour product teams, across GKE, Rancher RKE, Azure IaaS/Kubespray and AKS.

- Operated and modernized 10+ Kubernetes clusters across multiple clouds, up to 200 nodes each, serving 50 product teams.
- Led Kubespray to RKE and **RKE to AKS migration** with GitOps, immutable infrastructure and security guardrails, delivering high availability and zero-downtime cluster upgrades.
- Built self-service Kubernetes platform capabilities, **GreenIT** resource-efficiency practices, runbooks, alert tuning and active on-call incident response.
- Developed and contributed to Kubernetes controllers/operators for multi-tenancy, logging and platform automation.

**Software Engineer / Infrastructure Architect** Jan 2016 — Dec 2020  
Earlier engineering roles  
Airbus Group Inc. and Aestetype Design: Python network/security automation, Tufin/NetBox/Centreon/Palo Alto/IPFabric data flows, Jenkins/Vault foundations, and Docker/Kubernetes product modernization.

## OPEN SOURCE

**aslafy-z/helm-git** MAINTAINER  
Helm plugin to install charts and values straight from Git repositories. **360+ stars**.

**stakater/application** MAINTAINER  
Generic production Helm chart with schema-validated values. **370+ stars**.

**kube-logging/logging-operator** CORE CONTRIBUTOR  
Operator-driven log collection, routing and delivery as declarative resources. **1,600+ stars**.

**Ecosystem contributions** CONTRIBUTOR  
**1,000+ merged PRs:** Argo CD, Cilium, Kyverno, Talos, Helm, Kargo, Scaleway CCM, Ansible, Renovate, Prometheus Operator, External Secrets, Pluto...

**Production-grade homelab**  
Talos/Kubernetes GitOps lab validating platform patterns: Cilium, Rook/Ceph, SOPS/age, observability.

## SKILLS

**Platform Engineering**  
Kubernetes · Talos · AKS · GKE · EKS · RKE · kubeadm · Kubespray · Cluster API · Operators · Rook/Ceph · Docker · containerd · Harbor · Chaos engineering

**Developer Experience**  
Self-service platforms · Internal tooling · Helm · Kustomize · GitOps · Argo CD · Flux CD · Argo Rollouts · Argo Workflows · Kargo · KEDA · Renovate · GitHub Actions · GitLab CI · Jenkins

**Observability / Reliability**  
Prometheus · Thanos · Mimir · VictoriaMetrics · Alertmanager · Grafana · Loki · Fluent Bit · Fluentd · OpenTelemetry · Tempo · Incident response · Alert tuning · Runbooks · Zero-downtime upgrades

**Security / Supply chain**  
Kyverno · OPA · Gatekeeper · Falco · Trivy · Syft/Grype · Cosign · SBOM · Vault · External Secrets · cert-manager · Keycloak/OIDC · Velero

**Networking**  
Cilium · Calico · Gateway API · ingress-nginx · Traefik · Envoy Gateway · WireGuard

**Cloud / Edge / IaC**  
AWS · Azure · GCP · Scaleway · OVHcloud · Terraform · Crossplane · Ansible · Packer · NVIDIA Jetson

**Programming**  
Go · Python · TypeScript · Shell · Rust · C/C++

**AI**  
AI-assisted engineering · Agentic coding workflows · Developer automation · ChatOps · KServe · vLLM · LiteLLM · Computer vision · GPU compute

## EDUCATION

**University of Kent**  
MSc, Computer Science - Cyber Security  
Sep 2016 — Sep 2017

**EPITECH**  
Engineering degree, Computer Programming  
Dec 2013 — Dec 2018

## CERTIFICATIONS

**Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)**   
The Linux Foundation · Dec 2021

**Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)**   
The Linux Foundation · Feb 2023

## INTERESTS

**Technology**  
Technology watch · IoT · AI · Self-hosting · Local-first

**Sports & outdoors**  
Hiking · Rock climbing · Cycling

**Food & fermentation**  
Hot pepper sauces · Gourmet pickles · World cuisines

## LANGUAGES

|         |        |
|---------|--------|
| French  | Native |
| English | Fluent |